Deborah Alabi

B.A. Honours Psychology & Minor in English
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Psychology graduate and researcher with end-to-end experience in human subjects research: study design, participant recruitment, data collection, quantitative and qualitative analysis, and writing and presenting findings to academic, government, and community audiences. Skilled in Qualtrics, SPSS, and the Microsoft Office Suite, with applied experience in program evaluation, curriculum and resource development, volunteer training, and the coordination of multiple concurrent research and programming projects. Comfortable learning and supporting new research technologies, and known for organization, accuracy, discretion, and a calm, collaborative working style.

EDUCATION

B.A. Honours Psychology, Minor in English, June 2026
University of Winnipeg, Winnipeg, MB

- Undergraduate Thesis: Alexithymia and Attention-Emotion Interactions (2025 to 2026).
- Research focus: attention, systems thinking, learning systems, emotion, cognition and behavior, PTSD, grief, mental health policy, community psychology, and research translation.
- PRIME Student x Community Fellowship ($8,000), 2026; Dean's Honors List, 2023 to 2024; Vatrt Family Bursary ($3,522), 2023.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Primary Researcher, Undergraduate Honours Thesis, Sept 2025 to May 2026
University of Winnipeg, Winnipeg, MB

- Designed and ran an independent empirical study on alexithymia and attention-emotion interactions, taking the project from literature review and experimental design through to a written report under faculty supervision.
- Built and administered study materials in Qualtrics, recruited and scheduled participants, and ran data collection sessions following approved protocols.
- Cleaned, managed, and analyzed quantitative data in SPSS, then interpreted and wrote up results in scholarly format.
- Maintained detailed records of procedures, measures, and results to support reproducibility and supervisory review.

Researcher, Newcomer Youth Participatory Action Research Project, Nov 2023 to July 2024
Immigrant and Refugee Community Organization of Manitoba (IRCOM), Winnipeg, MB

- Recruited newcomer and refugee youth participants and designed and administered interviews, focus groups, and surveys assessing barriers across education and justice systems.
- Contributed to survey design and literature reviews and conducted both quantitative and qualitative analysis of the resulting data.
- Prepared research reports and presented findings to government representatives and community stakeholders at the IRCOM conference.
- Applied TCPS 2 ethical standards and maintained strict confidentiality when handling sensitive participant data.

Student Fellow, Jan 2026 to Aug 2026
PRIME Student x Community Fellowship, Winnipeg, MB

- Partnered with community organizations to translate research evidence into mental health policy and programming recommendations.
- Supported knowledge translation work connecting academic findings to practitioner and public audiences.

TEACHING, LEARNING AND PROGRAM SUPPORT

Tutor, Writer and Editor (Self-Employed), 2018 to Present
Freelance, Winnipeg, MB

- Tutor university and high school students, along with TOEFL candidates, in academic and creative writing, adapting instructional materials and pacing to each learner's level.
- Edit and proofread long-form academic work, including undergraduate theses and scholarly essays, with close attention to clarity, accuracy, and consistency.
- Plan and produce written and visual learning and communications materials across print and digital channels, tracking multiple client deadlines on an editorial calendar.

Volunteer Program Coordinator (Practicum), Oct 2025 to Present
African Immigrants Settlement in Canada (AISIC), Winnipeg, MB

- Deliver training sessions for volunteers through structured onboarding, covering protocols, expectations, and consistent standards of practice.

- Facilitate youth and family mentorship sessions and prepare participant-facing session materials, including slide decks and handouts.
- Coordinate session logistics, schedules, and materials across concurrent programming streams.

Curator and Project Lead, Meeting Rapha: Exploring Loss, Grief and Healing, Jan 2026 to July 2026
The Rapha Collective, The Edge Gallery and Urban Art Centre, Winnipeg, MB

- Planned and delivered a two-part community initiative from concept to completion, managing a six-month project calendar, venue and equipment logistics, and a detailed run-of-show used by seven teams on site.
- Translated grief and mental health research into an immersive, participatory format, designing a fictional world in which attendees explored loss and healing through narrative, visual art, and performance, an applied test of creative mediums as a public education tool for mental health.
- Recruited, briefed, and supervised 25+ volunteers and coordinated 7 to 8 exhibiting artists, allocating spaces, materials, and responsibilities across the program.
- Designed a five-question documentary interview guide and directed on-camera interviews and two photography collections, then oversaw post-event debriefing and documentation.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Newcomer Case Manager, Jan 2026 to Aug 2026
Resilia Community Wellness Centre (formerly Aurora Family Therapy Centre), Winnipeg, MB

- Conduct structured intake and eligibility assessments, often through interpreters, and produce accurate triage reports and confidential case documentation within organizational protocols.
- Authored the RNCM Resource Guide, closing a documented gap in staff onboarding and daily workflows, and built a multi-level English Language Pre-Class Support tool (Levels 1 to 5) for waitlisted clients.
- Coordinate with clinicians, interpreters, and partner agencies across multiple concurrent files and deadlines, responding to requests with tact and timeliness.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Alabi, D. (2024). Youth Perspectives on Addressing Racism in Schools. Talk presented at the Newcomer Participatory Research Project Conference (IRCOM), Winnipeg, Manitoba.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research and data: Qualtrics, SPSS, experimental design, survey and interview design, focus groups, participant recruitment and scheduling, quantitative and qualitative analysis, program evaluation, literature review, and research reporting.

Software and platforms: Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook); Microsoft Forms; Google Workspace; generative AI platforms (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) for drafting, summarizing, and materials development; Canva; Genially; Eventbrite; Slack; Zoom; CARMIS client management system; and learning management systems (Nexus).

Languages: English (fluent).

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Summer Institute in Program Evaluation (SIPE) 2026, Canadian Evaluation Society, Manitoba Chapter: weeklong intensive in program evaluation and evidence-informed decision-making, including evaluation plans developed for community agencies.
- TCPS 2: CORE, Research Ethics Certification.
- Certificate in Applied Psychology (in progress), University of Winnipeg.
- HRPP-E Facilitator (Healthy Relationships Plus Program, Enhanced).
- Crisis Counselling Skills Training, Klinic Community Health.
- CPR C & AED (First Aid).

REFERENCES

Dr. Stephen Smith, Professor of Psychology, University of Winnipeg, s.smith@uwinnipeg.ca

Aynslie Hinds, Professor of Psychology, University of Winnipeg, a.hinds@uwinnipeg.ca